

VOICE LEADING #1

FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #58

Voice Leading is the gift that keeps on giving - better composed melodies, better improvised solos, better chord voicings, and better arrangements. EVERYTHING that involves more than one note should involve Voice Leading.

Bb Blues - Voice Leading 3rds and 7ths

The image shows three staves of music for a Bb Blues progression. Each staff contains four measures of music, each with a chord symbol above it. The chords are: Gb7, Eb7, Gb7, Gb7 on the first staff; Eb7, Eb7, Gb7, Gb7 on the second staff; and Cm7, F7, Gb7, F7 on the third staff. The notation focuses on the 3rd and 7th of each chord, showing how they move from one measure to the next to create a smooth line.

Here is the Bb blues, with just the 3rds and 7ths of the chord written. Notice how the "top notes" create a smooth line - no jumping around. The bottom line does the same thing. Voice Leading!

Tenor Madness (Sonny Rollins) - Voice Leading

The image shows three staves of music for a Tenor Madness progression. Each staff contains four measures of music, each with a chord symbol above it. The chords are: Gb7, Eb7, Gb7, Gb7 on the first staff; Eb7, Eb7, Gb7, Gb7 on the second staff; and Cm7, F7, Gb7, Gb7, F7 on the third staff. The notation focuses on the 3rd and 7th of each chord, showing how they move from one measure to the next to create a smooth line. Red circles are drawn around the 3rd and 7th of each chord to highlight the voice leading.